



Acer's Aspire Revo gets upgraded with a dual-core Atom processor and Windows 7



OCZ's Z-Drive PCIe slot SSD gets tested and apparently has a great performance

Desktop PC test



Gateway ZX2301

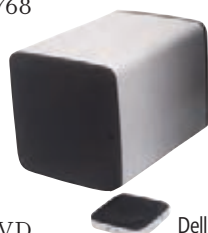
sub-woofer built at the back. While the sound quality isn't great, it definitely adds more punch to the sound than the speakers on all the all-in-one PC's speakers we've heard. The 18.5-inch screen has a basic 1366x768 pixel resolution. Below that are touch-sensitive buttons that respond to the multi-media interface overlayed on the OS. Below that we have a standard front-loading DVD writer. There's no dedicated button to turn the screen off. It has just one USB port at the side. Above that is a volume roller that also can be pressed to mute audio. The 160 GB hard disk should prove sufficient for storing basic stuff but we feel that they could have fit a larger hard drive in it. The compact keyboard is creaky and isn't very comfortable to type on. On the other hand, the mouse has a good grip and is quite easy to use.

Dell Inspiron 545s

The Inspiron 545s from Dell has a space-saving design. It's quite thin in comparison to typical cabinets, but its height is at-par with others. We got a cool red coloured

front top and you can choose from various colours when you buy one. There are cooling vents on one side and the top of the cabinet. That, and the rubber grips on corners of one side suggest that you could put it horizontally under a monitor to save some desk space.

It came with a set of equally cool-looking 2.1 speaker set



Dell Inspiron 545s

that emits quite decent audio quality. It also has a nice round volume pad on a wired remote with a side control for bass. The keyboard was quite soft to type on but it did not have any multimedia keys. The sheer performance advantage that this quad core processor has is staggering.

Intex (Gold GD-16431 and Platinum PM-16431)

Both Intex desktops, the Gold GD-16431 and the Platinum PM-16431 came in a standard-sized cabinet. The Platinum PM-16431 looks a little cooler than the Gold series thanks to the glossy black-and-silver front bezel. Both sport multimedia keyboards and standard optical mice which are pretty decent and usable. The Platinum series keyboard is slightly thinner. This model also comes with a set of horizontally-standing stereo speakers. They don't have a 3.5 mm headphone port, but rather connect via USB as a separate audio device. It gets detected automatically in Windows, but we couldn't use them with the Ubuntu Linux distribution. Secondly, the USB wire is too short. They provide acceptable sound quality.

Lenovo IdeaCentre A600

The Lenovo IdeaCentre A600 is probably the only Windows-based All-in-one



Lenovo IdeaCentre A600

machine we've seen that, although mimicking the iMac's concept, brings out enough innovation to give it a tough fight. It occupies almost the same amount of desk space as a 20-inch iMac. It looks pretty cool in its black shade. A pro over the iMacs we've tested; the A600 sports a 16:9 wide-screen aspect ratio screen that supports a full HD (1920 x 1080 pixel) resolution. It was a pleasure to watch a 1080p video on it. The screen is fairly bright and is crisp. On the right bottom, it has a slot-in DVD writer. There's a higher-end model also available with a Blu-ray drive – a perfect compliment to the high-def screen. Unlike the Mac, it has a host of ports (USB, FireWire) and a card reader on its side for easy access. We were slightly disappointed that the speakers did not belt out as much thump as much the iMac did. Volume was also slightly lacking.

You can't expect great performance out of this mobile processor but the graphics solution – the ATi Mobility Radeon 3650 really helps in performance in games. The Lenovo A600



Intex Gold GF-16431